Annual Report 2026

This report sets out what Riverside Council delivered for residents during 2026, how the budget was spent, and the priorities for the year ahead.

Highlights

- Library opening hours extended to seven days a week.
- Two new playgrounds opened in the east of the borough.
- Recycling rate rose to 58 per cent, the highest on record.

How to get involved

1. Read the draft plan on our website.
2. Come to a drop-in session at the library.
3. Send us your comments by 31 January.

The new east playground, opened in June.

The council works with community groups, schools and local businesses on every project. More information is on the council website, including the full accounts and the minutes of every meeting held during the year.

Visit riverside.example/annual-report

Budget

Spending stayed within the agreed budget for the third year running. The table shows the main service areas.

Service	Budget (£k)	Spent (£k)	Change
Libraries	1,240	1,198	-3%
Parks and playgrounds	2,050	2,210	+8%
Waste and recycling	4,800	4,655	-3%
Community grants	600	600	0%

Next year

In 2027 the council will focus on housing repairs, safer walking routes to school and a long-term plan for the river- side park, working closely with residents at every stage of the process.